

LAYREADER'S INSTRUCTION ANNOUNCING THE LESSONS

Morning & Evening Prayer (Rubrics bottom pg 9)

The Rule: Announce **Verse, then Chapter, then Book (small to large)** – “*Here beginneth the 4th verse of the 21st Chapter of the Book of the Prophet Isaiah.*” “*Here endeth the First Lesson.*”

Exceptions: When the reading begins with the 1st verse, *don't* announce the verse—just *start with the chapter number*: “*Here beginneth the 2nd Chapter of...*” Likewise, when the verse and chapter are both #1, just say, “*Here beginneth the Book of ...*”

Epistle at Holy Communion (Rubrics page 70)

The Rule: Announce **Chapter, Book, then Verse**--“*The Epistle is written in the 30th chapter of the Epistle of Blessed Paul the Apostle, to the Romans, beginning at the 14th verse.*” ... “*Here endeth the Epistle.*”

Exceptions and Special Cases: As to the naming of the chapter, book and verse there are *no exceptions*. However, some Epistle readings are *NOT Epistles*, that is, there is another writing being used instead of an Epistle. In this case, “*The **Lesson for the Epistle** is written...*”

“*Here endeth the **Lesson.***”

Naming of the Book can be done using St. Paul's name or not. Be aware of the 1st and 2nd Epistles, and remember how to call them out. Go slowly and systematically and you won't get tongue tied.

Epistles named for the author require their own format.

Examples: “*The Epistle is written in the 1st chapter of the 1st Epistle of Blessed Paul the Apostle to the Corinthians, beginning at the 2nd verse.*” - or -

“*The Epistle is written in the 1st chapter of the 1st Epistle to the Corinthians, beginning at the 2nd verse.*” (both okay)

“*The Epistle is written in the 1st chapter of the 1st Epistle General of Blessed Peter the Apostle, beginning at the 2nd verse.*”

“*The Epistle is written in the 1st chapter of the 1st Epistle of St Peter, beginning at the 2nd verse.*”

RULES ON NAMING OF BOOKS

- ❑ Genesis to Deuteronomy - “*The Book of Moses called Exodus*”
- ❑ Joshua to Ruth, Ezra to Job, Ecclesiastes & Song of Songs - “*The Book of Esther.*”
- ❑ 1 Samuel to 2 Chronicles - “*The 2nd Book of the Kings*”
- ❑ Major Prophets (Isaiah to Daniel) - “*The Book of the Prophet Jeremiah*”
- ❑ Minor Prophets (Hosea to Malachi) “*The Book of Micah*”
- ❑ Deuterocanonical Books (Apocrypha): similar rules as above
- ❑ Gospel - “*The (Holy) Gospel According to St. Mark*”
- ❑ Acts - “*The Acts of the Apostles*”
- ❑ Epistles - “*The Epistle to the Hebrews*” or as noted above
- ❑ Revelation - “*The Revelation of St. John (the Divine)*”
- ❑ **NEVER** call a New Testament “Book”: “*The Book of John.*”

- ❑ *Always* call the authors “*Saint*” or “*Blessed,*” not “*James.*”

- ❑ Whenever you pronounce the name “**Jesus,**” bow. Not at the title “*Christ.*”

Morning Prayer Guide (Matins)

1. Page 1-5: Read one or more of the sentences, according to the season, then proceed either to the invitation and confession, or directly to "O Lord, open thou our lips..."
2. If the Confession is used, it is preceded by either the long or short invitation.
3. The Confession is said *kneeling*.
4. Absolution may not be done except by a priest. If no priest: skip to the Lord's Prayer.
5. "O Lord, open..."
6. *Venite* ¶ *But NOTE, That on Ash Wednesday and Good Friday the Venite may be omitted.*
7. Follow *Venite*, Psalms, and Canticles (except *Te Deum*) with *Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost, as it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.* ("Gloria Patri")
8. Read appointed Psalms, either according to lectionary, or according to monthly cycle – shown on psalm pages at top.
9. First Lesson, according to lectionary. "Here beginneth the ___ verse of the ___ chapter of ___ (book).
10. "*Here endeth the First Lesson*"
11. *Te Deum* (preferred), or other two canticles, on occasion.
12. Second Lesson, according to lectionary. On Sunday, the Gospel lesson from Holy Communion may be substituted.
13. "*Here endeth the Second Lesson.*"
14. *Benedictus* (preferred) or *Jubilate Deo*, if more appropriate.
15. The Apostles' Creed, standing.
16. Responsories.
17. If not said earlier, the *Lord's Prayer* here.
18. Collect for the Day (or week – previous Sunday)
19. A Collect for Peace.
20. A Collect for Grace.
21. Optional prayers – according to the nature of the service.
22. *General Thanksgiving*, if used in congregational setting, will be recited by all.
23. Prayer of St. Chrysostom.
24. The Grace...

There is no Prayer Book direction for Hymnal use, or an offering or a sermon. This office was never meant to be the Sunday service, so you have to adapt it, if it is used so.

For Sunday service, best to insert sermon and offertory after the Creed. Hymns before service, perhaps between lessons, before sermon, and at end.

Evening Prayer Guide (Evensong)

1. Pg 21-22 Read one or more of the sentences as appropriate, then proceed either to the invitation and confession, or directly to "*O Lord, open thou our lips...*"
2. If the Confession is used, it is preceded by either the long or short invitation.
3. The Confession is said *kneeling*.
4. Absolution may not be done except by a priest. If no priest, skip to the Lord's Prayer.
5. "*O Lord, open...*"
6. Follow psalms, and canticles with *Gloria Patri...*
7. Read appointed psalms, either according to lectionary, or according to monthly cycle.
8. First Lesson, according to lectionary. "Here beginneth the ____ verse of the ____ chapter of ____ (book).
9. "*Here endeth the First Lesson*"
10. The *Magnificat*. (No other options).
11. Second Lesson, according to lectionary.
12. "*Here endeth the Second Lesson.*"
13. *Nunc Dimittis*. (No other options).
14. The Apostles' Creed.
15. Responsories
16. If not said earlier, the *Lord's Prayer* here.
17. Collect for the Day (or week, as in last Sunday)
18. A Collect for Peace.
19. A Collect for Aid against Perils.
20. Optional prayers
21. General Thanksgiving, if used in congregational setting, will be recited by all.
22. Prayer of St. Chrysostom.
23. The Grace...